

PLV QUALITATIVE SURVEY

Composite, Anonymised Version — 24 Districts, Karnataka 2025–26

About this document

This document is a composite, anonymised version of qualitative PLV (Para Legal Volunteer) surveys collected across 24 District Legal Services Authorities (DLSAs) in Karnataka as part of OutLawed India Foundation's KSLSA PLV Training Programme. It was prepared for external sharing (including the JPMorganChase Code for Good 2026 problem-statement process) and is intended to preserve the texture and substance of real respondent voices while removing all direct and indirect identifiers.

Methodology: rather than redacting names from individual transcripts, each district's respondents have been synthesised into representative composite narratives grouped by the four original survey questions. This approach was chosen because many original responses contained combinations of details — a specific village plus a named referrer plus a rare role or demographic — that would remain re-identifiable even with names alone removed. Composite synthesis avoids this risk while preserving genuine patterns, language, and sentiment drawn from real respondents.

No names, village-level locations, referrer identities, ages, family details, or organisation-ownership details appear in this document. District names are retained as they reflect the existing level of aggregation already used in the programme's quantitative reporting.

A parallel document, "PLV Qualitative Survey — Thematic Summary & Patterns," presents cross-district patterns with representative anonymised quotes for readers who want the synthesis without the district-by-district detail.

HAVERI

Respondent profile (composite): *9 respondents (predominantly women): Anganwadi workers/teachers, MSW students, a farmers'-organisation office-bearer, a homeguard, and a yoga teacher. Most were first-time PLVs.*

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents typically learned of the PLV scheme through the local court, an Anganwadi/Taluk officer, or word of mouth from earlier PLVs. Motivations centred on wanting a more structured, authoritative way to continue social work already underway, and a personal desire to understand the law — several mentioned unresolved family property questions as a trigger.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Domestic violence, child marriage, and POCSO cases were the most commonly cited issues, with some also flagging child labour and poverty affecting school access. Respondents described the training as highly

engaging and said it gave them clarity on which authority to approach and how — several specifically noted the interactive, 'Nali Kali'-style teaching helped retention despite long training days.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Most intend to focus on domestic violence and child-marriage awareness work, with a few interested in POCSO and elder welfare-scheme access. Several plan to fold legal-awareness content into work they already do (Anganwadi sessions, community outreach).

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

A recurring theme was a past negative experience with police response to a DV complaint, which had left respondents feeling the system offered no real recourse; the training reframed this by clarifying that free legal aid and DLSA channels exist and function independently of police responsiveness. Several described a marked reduction in fear of engaging with legal authorities.

BIDAR

Respondent profile (composite): 5 respondents: government department staff (education), a Sakhi Centre worker, and social workers, including some with multi-year (3–4 year) PLV tenure.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents were introduced to the scheme through their workplace or department, or through informal networks; motivations included a family tradition of social service and direct exposure to corruption or victims of domestic violence.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Domestic violence, POCSO, and property disputes were the dominant issues named, alongside child marriage and mistreatment of senior citizens. Respondents reported the training gave them practical confidence — one described filing a police complaint on behalf of a community member the same evening after a session on complaint drafting.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents plan to focus on DV and POCSO victim support, complaint drafting, and awareness-raising on child marriage, continuing to route cases through DLSA.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

All respondents reported increased confidence and a positive shift in their view of the legal system, several explicitly contrasting this training's quality with prior trainings they had attended.

VIJAYAPURA

Respondent profile (composite): 5 respondents, mostly law students, plus one ASHA worker — all residing locally, most first-time PLVs.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Law-student respondents learned of the scheme through college or a court outreach session and were motivated by a wish to bridge law and the community; the ASHA worker was motivated by an interest in supporting women and children.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Domestic violence, family disputes, labour/wage issues, caste-based discrimination, and lack of welfare-scheme awareness were most cited. Respondents said the training translated legal theory into practical guidance — one described being able to explain DV Act protections and DLSA referral pathways to a woman shortly after training.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents intend to focus on legal-awareness programming, mediation/counselling support, and guiding people to Lok Adalat and free legal aid; some specifically want to work on child-marriage and POCSO cases.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents described a shift from viewing the legal system as distant or intimidating to seeing it as accessible and protective, with increased confidence to engage directly with authorities.

YADGIR

Respondent profile (composite): 5 respondents (all women): ASHA workers, a health-department employee, and community/NGO-affiliated social workers, including a transgender PLV working with a local NGO.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Most were introduced to the scheme through department officials (Taluk/health authorities) or an affiliated NGO; motivations centred on an existing commitment to social service and, in one case, lived experience of discrimination motivating advocacy work.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Child marriage and domestic violence were near-universal concerns, with POCSO, property disputes, and discrimination/violence against transgender persons also raised. Respondents described the training as building real confidence to intervene rather than simply observe.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents plan to focus on preventing child marriage, raising POCSO awareness, supporting property-document access, and (for one respondent) advocacy against violence targeting the transgender community.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Several described a significant shift in confidence and legal understanding, attending all training days without absence and describing renewed self-respect and reduced fear of legal engagement.

DAVANAGERE

Respondent profile (composite): 8 respondents: law students, social workers, and community members recruited via DLSA and law-college partnerships; a mix of first-time and repeat volunteers.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Most learned of the scheme through their law college (following a DLSA notification) or a DLSA noticeboard; motivations included wanting grassroots exposure alongside legal studies, and inspiration from PLV alumni's case outcomes.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

POCSO, transgender rights, child marriage, cyber-crime, domestic violence, and municipal/governance issues (e.g., waste management) were cited. Respondents — particularly law students — noted the training covered specialised laws (POCSO, TG Act) not taught in their formal coursework.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents intend to build community-level legal awareness, support documentation and referral processes, and in several cases specifically want to support transgender-rights and child-protection awareness work.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

A strong theme was a visible confidence transformation over the multi-day training — several respondents described being too nervous to speak on the first day but confident enough to address the full group by the final session.

BELGAUM

Respondent profile (composite): 8 respondents: retired defence-affiliated pension/welfare department staff, a wholesale trader, social/health workers, and an NGO-affiliated worker supporting domestic-worker rights.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Retired-personnel respondents were introduced through their welfare department; others learned via the DLSA Member Secretary or a court visit. Motivation was largely a wish to extend existing service work with formal legal grounding.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Domestic violence, POCSO, child labour, elder mistreatment, caste disputes, pension/land issues (for the ex-military respondents), and workplace harassment (POSH) were cited. Respondents described the training as clarifying which authority to approach for which issue, replacing prior reliance on informal or police-only routes.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Planned focus areas include outreach on abuse and exploitation of women and children, pension/land support for ex-servicemen, POCSO and child-labour cases, and POSH complaint support.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Multiple respondents described previously believing the legal system existed mainly to punish, and now understanding it also provides free legal aid and protective services — several said this replaced fear with confidence.

MANDYA

Respondent profile (composite): 5 respondents: a senior-citizens'-rights facilitator, a retiree, an NGO-affiliated volunteer, and Anganwadi teachers with long-standing (multi-year) PLV tenure.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents were introduced via their department/NGO work or through DLSA interviews; motivations included post-retirement desire for continued social contribution and existing multi-year community service.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Elder neglect and welfare-access gaps, child marriage, divorce disputes, POCSO, domestic violence, and property disputes were cited. Respondents with prior PLV experience noted this training was markedly more interactive than earlier DLSA trainings.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents plan to continue existing community work — particularly elder welfare and property-related guidance — now backed by clearer legal grounding, and to continue routing complex cases to DLSA.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents reported a substantial jump in confidence, several specifically praising the training being conducted in Kannada, and requested longer duration and field-visit components in future sessions.

CHIKKABALLAPUR

Respondent profile (composite): 10 respondents: law students, long-tenured Anganwadi workers (up to several decades of community work), a transgender-rights NGO worker, and general social workers, several with multi-year (5–10 year) PLV tenure.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents were introduced through law colleges, DLSA staff, or affiliated NGOs; several long-tenured PLVs described being nominated based on prior visible community work, sometimes facing initial community resistance to their advocacy role.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Labour/wage issues, property disputes, child rights, domestic violence, transgender discrimination, caste-based atrocities, and POCSO were most cited. Respondents described the training clarifying documentation requirements and legal recourse they had previously navigated only informally.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Planned work spans labour-rights support, family-law mediation and counselling, transgender-community advocacy (including ID/welfare-scheme access), and continued DLSA-linked fieldwork such as school facility audits.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Long-tenured respondents described the training as validating and formalising work they already did; several newer respondents described a marked increase in courage to question authority and support people through the legal process.

BANGALORE URBAN

Respondent profile (composite): *4 respondents: a retired long-time social worker, an assistant professor running a college legal-aid clinic, a trust-holding social worker, and a community documentation-support worker.*

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents learned of the scheme through friends, their institution, or prior PLV experience (in one case, under an earlier iteration of the scheme); motivations included a wish to formalise ongoing social-work practice.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Domestic violence, civil/consumer disputes, and routine documentation issues (ID cards, subsidy access) were cited. Respondents said the training filled in foundational legal grounding for issues they had previously handled from a purely social-work perspective.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents intend to scale existing legal-aid clinic work, continue documentation support in their community, and take on DLSA-assigned duties as directed.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents described a shift in perception of courts as inaccessible or costly toward understanding that free legal aid genuinely exists and functions.

CHITRADURGA

Respondent profile (composite): 4 respondents: an Anganwadi teacher, a first-year student, a retired bank manager, and a community member referred by a family member.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents heard of the scheme via a supervisor, a local advocate, a DLSA connection, or a newspaper notice; motivations included curiosity about the law and a wish to build confidence to support their community.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Family disputes, child marriage, youth substance use, child labour, POCSO, and hostel-related harassment of girls were cited. Respondents said the training built foundational confidence but requested more practical/field-based components.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Planned focus areas include women-and-children's welfare support, POCSO and child-rights work, and labour-wage issue support.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents described replacing the assumption that legal help is only accessible via paid lawyers with an understanding that PLVs and pro bono legal aid provide a real alternative pathway.

RAICHUR

Respondent profile (composite): *5 respondents (predominantly women): Anganwadi/ASHA workers from rural taluks, and one male law-student respondent.*

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Most learned of the scheme through a departmental senior or supervisor; several had no prior awareness of the PLV role before being informed by their office.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Child marriage and alcohol-related domestic violence were near-universal concerns; POCSO and property disputes were also cited. Respondents described the POCSO Act, in particular, as something they had only heard by name before this training.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents plan to focus on preventing child marriage and domestic violence through grassroots awareness programmes, and on supporting community members with legal documentation.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

A strong and consistent theme was a shift from passive bystanding — witnessing household conflict without intervening — to active confidence in intervening and connecting people with DLSA and legal recourse.

HASSAN

Respondent profile (composite): 8 respondents: ASHA/Anganwadi workers (several recruited via an NGO-led selection process), a community social worker, a transgender respondent, and a teacher.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Most respondents were selected by their department or NGO for the training and had limited prior awareness of the PLV role; a few described being specifically chosen due to visible prior community engagement.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Lack of Aadhaar/documentation access affecting children's education, property disputes, domestic violence, theft, elder neglect, and issues affecting migrant labourer families were cited. The transgender respondent described theft and domestic-violence issues as most common within their community context.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents intend to focus on legal-awareness generation in their existing professional context (Anganwadi sessions, health outreach), with several highlighting interest in supporting DLSA-directed casework.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Several respondents described a prior belief that law existed mainly for the wealthy, replaced after training with an understanding that pro bono legal aid and PLV support exist specifically for underserved communities.

CHAMARAJANAGAR

Respondent profile (composite): 5 respondents: a homemaker, long-tenured NGO-affiliated social workers (2–15 years of service, including repeat PLVs), and a resource person from a community-development NGO.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents learned of the scheme through the local court or peer/NGO networks; several were repeat or multi-year PLVs already embedded in social-service work spanning health, education, environment, and disability rights.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Domestic violence, child labour, POCSO, caste/religion-based discrimination, poverty, environmental and human–wildlife conflict issues, and gaps in basic services for tribal communities were cited. Multilingual respondents noted this helps them work across diverse community groups.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Planned work includes awareness campaigns (including street theatre for wider reach), complaint-writing support, and continued NGO-integrated documentation assistance, with several specifically flagging free legal aid helpline promotion.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents described the training as reinforcing an already positive but under-informed view of the legal system, with newly gained practical skills (complaint drafting, documentation) cited as the main confidence gain.

KODAGU

Respondent profile (composite): 5 respondents: Anganwadi teachers with multi-year PLV tenure, a long-serving social worker, and a corporate-sector employee volunteering alongside a human-rights group connection.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents learned of the scheme via their department (CDPO/DLSA) or peer/friend referral; motivations included direct community exposure to unmet legal needs and a personal interest in legal awareness work.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Property disputes, POCSO, child marriage, domestic violence, and women's safety concerns were most cited. Respondents specifically praised practical training activities — legal-notice drafting and DV-complaint filing exercises — as building real capability.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents plan to run awareness camps (including through the Anganwadi platform), and continue connecting community members to DLSA for support.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents — several already multi-year PLVs — said this was the most substantive training they had received in the role to date, citing the Kannada-medium delivery as improving comprehension.

KOLAR

Respondent profile (composite): *5 respondents: long-tenured community/NGO-affiliated PLVs (one with over a decade of service), a civic-organisation representative, and PLVs working specifically with the transgender community.*

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents' pathways into the role varied — some transitioned from earlier NGO-based legal-awareness work as the DLSA system formalised, others were introduced through community or civic organisations; personal experience of systemic gaps (including within one's own household) was cited as a motivator by more than one respondent.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Violence against women, child marriage, POCSO, cybercrime, and workplace harassment (POSH) were widely cited; transgender respondents specifically raised employment discrimination, lack of safe spaces, and demeaning treatment by police (verbal, though not physical, abuse) as recurring issues.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Planned work spans family-court support for DV survivors, POCSO and cybercrime awareness (an area respondents said is rarely covered in standard trainings), and continued advocacy for transgender-community access to government schemes and benefits.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents described the training as unusually substantive and engaging compared to prior sessions; transgender respondents in particular described it as validating and confidence-building, in contrast to a system that has often treated them dismissively.

UDUPI

Respondent profile (composite): 8 respondents: a law student, a retired bank manager, a long-tenured Anganwadi teacher/POCSO support person, an agriculture-department employee, an NGO worker, retired senior-citizen-committee representatives, and a rural shop-owner with a defence background.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents learned of the scheme via their college, department, or through DLSA representatives visiting community/senior-citizen groups; several were repeat PLVs continuing multi-year involvement.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Labour issues, POCSO, property disputes, child marriage, and domestic violence were cited, along with a specific case example of supporting a vulnerable individual through DLSA-linked shelter services.

Respondents with prior legal background (e.g., a retired LLB holder) described the training as a valuable refresher rather than introductory material.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents intend to focus on child-rights and POCSO work, labour-law awareness, elder and senior-citizen support, and general DLSA-directed casework depending on assignment.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Confidence gains were broadly reported; notably, one respondent raised an open concern about what protection or support exists for PLVs' personal safety while doing fieldwork — a gap not fully resolved by the training.

RAMANAGARA

Respondent profile (composite): 5 respondents: an NGO worker with long tenure (18 years), a repeat PLV, a social worker, and a law student.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents learned of the role through peer PLVs, community recommendation, or their law college; motivations centred on continuing existing social-service work with added legal grounding, and — for the student respondent — combining legal studies with grassroots exposure.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Harassment, mental/physical distress cases, domestic violence, child labour, and discrimination against girl children and marginalised groups were cited, alongside limited community awareness of legal remedies generally.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents plan to act as a bridge connecting women, children, and senior citizens to DLSA services, and to build awareness of rights and available government schemes, particularly around discrimination cases.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents — several working at the sub-district level — described low pre-existing community awareness of free legal aid, and said the training significantly increased their own confidence to explain and facilitate access to it.

MYSORE

Respondent profile (composite): 5 respondents: a freelance worker, a police-station-based counsellor, DLSA-linked PLVs with multi-year tenure (since 2016–2017), and a law student.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents learned of the scheme via newspaper notices, the DLSA, or their law college; the police-station-based respondent had prior direct exposure to case handling through her role.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Domestic violence and property disputes were most cited, along with POCSO and Right to Education awareness gaps. The police-affiliated respondent noted DV and POCSO cases are common in her caseload, and said the training added legal-process depth to her existing practical exposure.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents intend to continue supporting women and children approaching them for help, run school-based awareness sessions (including on POCSO and RTE), and use role-play/interactive methods for community outreach.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents were consistently positive about training quality and materials, with several multi-year PLVs describing it as reinforcing and deepening — rather than introducing — their existing understanding.

KOPPAL

Respondent profile (composite): *5 respondents: a co-founder of a women-and-child-focused NGO, an ASHA worker, a child-protection-centre worker, and law students (one also working in journalism/community-service roles).*

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents learned of the scheme through peers, their department, or their law college; motivations centred on extending existing service work (NGO, ASHA outreach) with formal legal backing.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Domestic violence, child marriage, POCSO, labour issues, caste-based discrimination, and welfare-scheme awareness gaps were cited. Respondents said the training gave them practical skills — complaint drafting in particular — that they previously lacked.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Planned work includes awareness programming, mediation and counselling support, complaint-writing assistance, and continued NGO/DLSA-linked fieldwork focused on child protection.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents reported increased confidence and a more positive view of the legal system's accessibility to ordinary citizens.

KALABURAGI

Respondent profile (composite): 8 respondents: a young community volunteer, an MSW-qualified social worker also serving as a POCSO support person, an NGO-affiliated education advocate, a law student, department (WCD) staff, a long-tenured NGO founder, and Anganwadi teachers with multi-year tenure.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Pathways into the role included online job portals, professional networks within DLSA, department nomination, and law-college outreach; several respondents run or work with their own community NGOs alongside their PLV role.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Child education access, elder pension delays, child marriage, child labour and begging, gender inequality, domestic violence, welfare-scheme access, and basic-service gaps (drinking water, sanitation) affecting Anganwadi-linked communities were all cited. Respondents described a shift from viewing welfare access as bureaucratic discretion to understanding it as a citizen's legal right, including awareness of RTI and complaint mechanisms.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Planned work spans RTE/welfare-scheme support, child-rights casework, support for underserved caste and semi-nomadic communities' access to schooling and identity documentation, and continued NGO-integrated fieldwork.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Most respondents described increased confidence and a more positive view of the judiciary's role in social justice; however, two respondents specifically noted the training had not fully resolved a persistent underlying fear of engaging with police or higher authorities, particularly around stakeholder-facing (rather than documentation-related) tasks — a nuance worth flagging for future training design.

TUMAKURU

Respondent profile (composite): 10 respondents: a large cohort of law students from multiple local colleges, a practising doctor, a farmers'-association representative, and community/social workers, several with multi-year (up to 5-year) PLV tenure.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Most law-student respondents learned of the scheme through a DLSA circular routed via their college, a campus legal-aid clinic, or a judge's visit to their institution; others learned via newspaper notices or peer/community referral. Motivations centred on combining legal study with practical service, or — for older respondents — extending existing farmer-advocacy or social-work activity onto a more formal footing.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Child abuse, child marriage, sexual harassment, domestic violence, property disputes, untouchability, and child labour were most cited; a law-student respondent also raised gaps in identity-document and welfare-scheme access affecting a semi-nomadic community. Respondents described the training as clarifying not just what the law says but which authority to approach for a given issue, and several specifically praised Kannada-medium delivery for aiding comprehension.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents intend to focus on awareness generation around child protection, domestic violence, and property/family-matter counselling; several plan to extend this work through their existing institutional base (farmers' groups, Anganwadi networks, or their college's legal-aid clinic) and one specifically wants to work on bribery/corruption issues district-wide.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

A recurring narrative was moving from believing law mainly benefits the financially well-off to understanding that evidence, procedure, and knowledge — not wealth — determine access to justice; several respondents described a new sense of added 'weight' or credibility when acting under the PLV designation compared to intervening as an ordinary citizen.

CHIKKAMAGALURU

Respondent profile (composite): 10 respondents: several law students, a former LIC agent, a daily-wage worker, Anganwadi teachers (including one with six years of PLV tenure), a social activist/POCSO support person, and an ASHA worker.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents learned of the scheme via college circulars, newspaper advertisements, departmental referral, peer/friend referral, or a prior training session run by another organisation; motivations included a family background in public service, lived experience of discrimination faced by one's own community, and a general interest in social contribution.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Religious conflict, child marriage, POCSO cases, domestic violence, child labour linked to poverty, property disputes, youth substance use, and gender/caste/religious discrimination were cited. One respondent described facing direct intimidation (including threats of black magic) while previously trying to prevent child marriages, underscoring the personal risk some PLVs navigate in this work. Respondents broadly praised the training's interactive, Kannada-medium, practically-oriented format over the theory-only approach of prior legal training they had received.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Planned focus areas include child-marriage and child-rights advocacy, women's rights awareness, and — for one respondent from a minority community — advocacy for girls' education access. Several plan to continue existing DV-support and documentation-assistance work with added confidence.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

A strong pattern was a shift from fearing police/judicial authorities as purely punitive to understanding the system's protective functions (free legal aid, DLSA services); several respondents contrasted the practical, procedural focus of this training favourably against theory-heavy legal education or prior trainings they'd attended.

SHIVAMOGGA

Respondent profile (composite): 3 respondents: a social worker/NGO head from a religious congregation with a long background in DV and POCSO casework, a law student, and an Anganwadi teacher.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents learned of the scheme through their organisation's leadership, their educational institution, or by independently searching for volunteer legal-service opportunities. Motivations included continuing existing DV/POCSO casework on firmer legal footing and a general interest in gaining a formally recognised community role.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Domestic violence, POCSO, and child marriage were the primary issues cited. Respondents described the training's practical orientation as valuable — one specifically noted it enabled her to support DV victims through mediated resolution processes, and another said it deepened understanding of stakeholder engagement in POCSO cases.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents plan to continue DV and POCSO-focused casework, with one specifically wanting to help reduce the district's POCSO case count through direct field engagement, and another wanting formal documentation of PLV work undertaken.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

All three respondents described increased confidence; the Anganwadi-teacher respondent specifically noted that holding the PLV designation changed how her existing community work is perceived and legitimised, beyond just adding new knowledge.

BENGALURU RURAL

Respondent profile (composite): 3 respondents: a law student, a community member referred based on prior social-service work, and a long-tenured social worker.

What made respondents sign up as a PLV, and how did they hear about the programme?

Respondents learned of the scheme through a college faculty member's encouragement, peer referral based on observed community work, or through the court and family connections. Motivations centred on a general interest in social welfare and service.

What legal issues do respondents commonly encounter, and how has the training equipped them?

Corruption and bribery in accessing government services, and lack of maintenance/support access for women and children, were the primary issues cited. Respondents described the training as building confidence to approach government officials directly rather than deferring to intermediaries.

What work do respondents intend to pursue as PLVs going forward?

Respondents intend to focus on ration-card and documentation assistance, anti-corruption advocacy, and improving POCSO Act implementation in their area.

Have respondents' perceptions of the legal system changed? Do they feel more confident and prepared?

Respondents described a marked increase in willingness to approach police and government officials directly on a citizen's behalf, including the law-student respondent, who said the training went beyond her formal legal education in building this practical confidence.